

Sacred Shiva Yatra

Indian Railways has announced a special Bharat Gaurav train package for devotees of Lord Shiva, offering an 11-night/12-day pilgrimage to seven sacred Jyotirlingas. Starting November 18 from Yoga City Rishikesh, the journey will cover Omkareshwar, Mahakaleshwar, Nageshwar, Somnath, Trimbakeshwar, Bhimashankar and Grishneshwar, along with visits to Dwarkadhish and Bet Dwarka. The package, priced at Rs 24,100 in Sleeper class, Rs 40,890 in 3AC, and Rs 54,390 in 2AC, includes train travel, accommodation in budget hotels, vegetarian meals, insurance and services of tour managers. With up to 33 per cent discount under the Bharat Gaurav Yojana, this pilgrimage ensures comfort, devotion and heritage on the move. Bookings can be made via IRCTC's website or authorised outlets.

ROLLING IN LUXURY

A new luxury train in Thailand, The Blue Jasmine, promises an unforgettable nine-day journey through the country's cultural heartlands. Launching on November 16, the boutique-style train will carry just 37 guests in plush cabins, with wraparound windows and refined interiors. Starting in Bangkok, it will take in Ayutthaya, Uthai Thani, Chiang Mai and Sukhothai, blending temple tours, farm-to-table dining and artisan workshops.

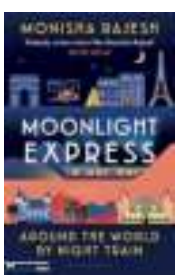
Image courtesy of DTH TRAVEL THAILAND



Prices begin at 195,000 baht (Rs 541,575) per person. See thebluejasmine.dth.travel

Train Tales and Tails





Two new books celebrate the romance and adventure of train travel in delightfully different ways. In *Midnight Express*, travel writer Monisha Rajesh takes readers aboard some of the world's most enchanting night trains, from the Orient Express to the Andean Explorer, revelling in moonlit landscapes and eccentric encounters. Meanwhile, Divya Dugar's *Chaos in a Coupe* offers a witty account of journeys across India with her partner, child and three rescue dogs in tow.